

JULIAN LEE-SURSIN

Curriculum Vitae — September 2026

✉ julian.sursin@ens.psl.eu 🌐 julianleesursin.com

Research Interests: Cognitive Science, Language, Mind, Science, Epistemology

APPOINTMENT

Visiting Scholar (*chercheur invité*), JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY, 2025–2026
Department of Comparative Thought and Literature (CTL)
Report available here: julianleesursin.com/Rapport_de_sejour_final.pdf

EDUCATION

ÉCOLE NORMALE SUPÉRIEURE, **MS** in Cognitive Science 2024–present
17/20 GPA (first year)¹

JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY, Visiting Graduate Student (CTL) 2025–2026

SORBONNE UNIVERSITÉ, **MPhil**, 2023–2025
Mention très bien (highest honors)
Spécialité : Philosophie des sciences, de la connaissance et de l'esprit

OBERLIN COLLEGE, **BA**, French and Philosophy, Honors in Philosophy 2020–2023

PAPERS

2. Lee-Sursin, Julian (forthcoming, 2026) “Panpsychism and the Individuation Problem: Comments on Taofeek”
Southwest Philosophy Review, 42 (2)
1. Lee-Sursin, Julian and Ryoo, Hong Joo (2026) “A Regress Argument Concerning Autonomous Self-Correction in AI Agents”
Preprint: <https://philsci-archive.pitt.edu/id/eprint/30629>

IN PREPARATION (Drafts available upon request)

- “Is Acquaintance a *Sui Generis* Relation?”
Manuscript, *Winner of the Indiana Philosophical Association 2025 Graduate Paper Prize*
- “A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism”
- “Subject-Dependence in Science: The Argument from Complementarity” (with Hong Joo Ryoo)
- A paper on why-questions
- A paper on composition and metalinguistic negotiation
- A paper on mental models and informativeness
- A paper on the inferences we make from Brain-Model Alignment

¹Grades in France are assigned on a scale from 0–20. An average of 10 is passing, 12 awards honors (*mention assez bien*), 14 awards high honors (*mention bien*), and 16 awards highest honors (*mention très bien*).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* = abstract refereed ** = paper refereed † = invited

-
- | | |
|--|-----------------|
| 26. New work on why-questions, title TBD (*)
American Philosophical Association, Eastern Division Meeting, Boston, MA
Papers in Progress Workshop | Jan 13-16, 2027 |
| 25. “Is Acquaintance a <i>Sui Generis</i> Epistemic Relation?” (**)
Southwest Philosophical Society Annual Meeting, El Paso, TX | Nov 13-14, 2026 |
| 24. “A Truthmaker Semantics for Constraint-Based Explanation” (**)
Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Normal, IL | Oct 16-17, 2026 |
| 23. “A Regress Argument Concerning Autonomous Self-Correction in AI Agents” (*)
(with Hong Joo Ryoo)
SOPhiA, Salzburg, Austria | Sep 4, 2026 |
| 22. “Presentism Precludes Explanation” (**)
European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain | Aug 28, 2026 |
| 21. “Curb Your (Brain-Model Alignment) Enthusiasm” (*)
(with Arnold Fleishman)
European Congress of Analytic Philosophy, Madrid, Spain | Aug 26, 2026 |
| 20. “A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism” (**)
Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Reading, UK | July 10, 2026 |
| 19. “An Explanatory Cognitive Model for Blackwell Informativeness” (*)
International Conference on Model-Based Reasoning, Rome, Italy | June 18, 2026 |
| 18. “Answering Why-Questions” (*)
Swedish Congress of Philosophy, Stockholm, Sweden | June 13, 2026 |
| 17. “On Fashion’s Perceptual Content” (**)
European Society for Aesthetics, Jyväskylä, Finland | June 9, 2026 |
| 16. “Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation?” (*)
Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD | Apr 25, 2026 |
| 15. “On Fashion’s Perceptual Meaning” (**)
American Society for Aesthetics, Eastern Division Meeting, Philadelphia, PA | Apr 10, 2026 |
| 14. “On Why-Questions” (†)
Semantics Lab, Department of Cognitive Science, JHU, Baltimore, MD | April 9, 2026 |
| 13. “A Semantic Argument Against Radical Cognitivism” (**)
University of Florida Graduate Philosophy Conference, Gainesville, FL | April 4, 2026 |
| 12. “Why Presentism Precludes Explanation” (*)
American Philosophical Association, Central Division Meeting, Chicago, IL
Philosophy of Time Society, Affiliated Group Session | Feb 18, 2026 |
| 11. “How Causation Explains: A Semantic Inquiry” (*)
American Philosophical Association, Eastern Division Meeting, Baltimore, MD
Society for Philosophy of Causation, Affiliated Group Session | Jan 7, 2026 |

- | | |
|---|---------------|
| 10. “Fashion and the Jacksonian Mode: Intentionality Beyond Language” (**)
Symposium, Institut Français de la Mode, Paris, France | Nov 20, 2025 |
| 9. “Semantics for Explanation” (**)
Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Charleston, IL | Nov 8, 2025 |
| 8. “Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation” (†)
Talk for philosophy majors and faculty, Oberlin College, Oberlin, OH | Nov 3, 2025 |
| 7. “Is Acquaintance a <i>Sui Generis</i> Epistemic Relation?” (**)
Indiana Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Bloomington, IN | Nov 1, 2025 |
| 6. “Semantics for Explanation” (**)
University of Toronto Grad Conference, Toronto, Canada | Oct 24, 2025 |
| 5. “Is Acquaintance a <i>Sui Generis</i> Epistemic Relation?” (*)
CREPH: Mind Conference, Liège, Belgium | Oct 16, 2025 |
| 4. “Do AI Agents Meet the Epistemic Norms for Explanation?” (*)
International Ontology Congress, Basque Country | Oct 9, 2025 |
| 3. “The Special Questions Dispute” (**)
SOPhiA, Salzburg, Austria | Sep 5, 2025 |
| 2. “The Special Questions Dispute” (**)
Joint Session of the Aristotelian and Mind Societies, Glasgow, Scotland | July 13, 2025 |
| 1. “Composition and Metalinguistic Negotiation” (†)
Salvador Mascarenhas Lab Meeting, Institut Jean Nicod, Paris, France | May 9, 2025 |

COMMENTS (†)

- Jiusi Guo: “Knowledge, Inquiry, and Taking Epistemic Logic Seriously” Oct 16-17, 2026
Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Normal, IL
- Jon Joey Telebrico: “Epistemic Debt and Responsibility” Apr 25, 2026
Inaugural Humanities of AI Workshop, JHU, Baltimore, MD
- Adekunle Taofeek: “The Individuation Problem for Plant Souls in Panpsychist Ontology” Nov 22, 2025
Southwest Philosophical Society Annual Meeting, Savannah, GA
- Patrick Skeels: “There can be no Dispute” Nov 8, 2025
Illinois Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, Charleston, IL

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS (Selected)

- | | |
|--|-----------|
| 9. Research Fellowship , Johns Hopkins University (\$12,000)
Fellowship stipend to conduct research as a Visiting Scholar | 2025–2026 |
| 8. Tuition Subsidy , Johns Hopkins University (\$66,670)
Full subsidy to take any course(s) as a visiting graduate student | 2025–2026 |
| 7. Honorarium , Institut Français de la Mode (€1,600)
Award for presentation at the Fashion and Language Symposium | Nov 2025 |
| 6. Graduate Paper Prize (\$100)
Indiana Philosophical Association Annual Meeting, best paper by a grad student | Oct 2025 |

5. **Bursary**, CREPH ARC research project: MIND (€500) Aug 2025
Funding for presentation at the University of Liège
4. **Travel Grant**, Sorbonne Philosophy Department (€500) May 2025
Funding for 2025 Joint Session presentation in Glasgow
3. **Paul W. Wurzburger Prize in French** (\$1,000) May 2023
Concours de la Maison Française de Cleveland, affiliated with the Alliance Française
2. **Prix Lahaurine-Johnston** (\$1,000) May 2022
Annual prize for investment in Oberlin's Maison Française
1. **John F. Oberlin Merit Scholarship** (\$30,000 total) 2020–2023
Merit scholarship, renewed for all three years I was at Oberlin

TEACHING

- OBERLIN COLLEGE 2021–2023
- Sole Grader and Tutor, Deductive Logic
 - Tutor: Philosophy, French, Math, CS, Latin, Econ
 - Sole Resident Assistant, Maison Française (2022–2023)
 - TA (weekly session as sole instructor), Intermediate French (Spring 2021)
- US MILITARY / ROCHESTER INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY Summer 2021
- Sole instructor: Robotics, CS, and Biochem courses for the Army Educational Outreach Program

EMPIRICAL RESEARCH

- MICHIGAN STATE UNIVERSITY, Arnosti Lab Summer 2019
- Investigated modified retinoblastoma (Rbf) gene in *Drosophila* using dCas9 chimeras
- FLORIDA STATE UNIVERSITY, Arbeitman Lab Summer 2018
- Tasked with CRISPR & U6-gRNA cloning, *Drosophila* cortex dissection, and gel electrophoresis
- NATIONAL HIGH MAGNETIC FIELD LABORATORY, Condensed Matter Lab 2015–2017
(under the supervision of Johan van Tol)
- Designed a millimeter wave resonator. When measuring polymers (e.g., polystyrene), intensity increased by a factor of 8 and pulselengths decreased by a factor of 3-4 (compared to measurements without the resonator).
 - Built miniature solar-powered vehicle using CAD and soldering

SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

Referee: NeurIPS (Neural Information Processing Systems), 2026 Workshop on Interpreting Agent Behavior

Member: American Philosophical Association (Eastern), American Society for Aesthetics, Aristotelian Society, European Society for Aesthetics, European Society for Analytic Philosophy, Philosophy of Time Society, Society for Philosophy of Causation, Southwestern Philosophical Society

Board Member: Youth Advisory Board, National High Magnetic Field Laboratory (2021–2023)

Editor: *The Synapse: Intercollegiate science magazine* (2021–2022)

VARIA

Fashion: I performed in Paris Fashion Week (*Duranimal*) and the Saut Hermès Dinner Mar 2025

Music: I sing (bass) in the *Choeur de l'Orchestre de Paris*. I used to sing at Oberlin and the Peabody. Notable performances include:

- Verdi's *Macbeth* (Salle Gaveau), ft. Plácido Domingo Apr 1, 2025
- Rossini's *Le Comte Ory* (Théâtre des Champs-Élysées), ft. Cyrille Dubois Nov 7, 2024
- Bastille Day Parade, ft. the Olympic torch July 14, 2024
- Works of Joe Hisaishi (La Défense Arena), dir. Joe Hisaishi Apr 6-7, 2024
- Mozart's Mass in C minor (Les Invalides), dir. Claire Gibault Dec 5, 2023
- Choral Evensong at New College and Queen's College, Oxford Apr 22-23, 2023

GRADUATE COURSEWORK

- **École Normale Supérieure²**
 - Cognitive Models and Artificial Intelligence (Fall 2026, Heike Stein)
 - Evolutionary Foundations of Social and Cultural Behaviors (Fall 2026, Nicolas Baumard & Jean-Baptiste André)
 - Neurons, Networks, and Behavior (Fall 2026, Karim Benchenane)
 - Perception, Memory, and Core Knowledge (Fall 2026, Claudia Lunghi, Pascal Mamassian & Marine Lunven)
 - Producing and Using Data in Cognitive Science (Fall 2026, Daniel Nettle)
 - Semantics (Spring 2025, Salvador Mascarenhas)
 - Language (Fall 2024, Salvador Mascarenhas)
 - Representational Foundations of Mind (Fall 2024, Denis Buehler)
- **Johns Hopkins University** (Audited)
 - Advanced Topics in Philosophy of Mind and Cognitive Science (Spring 2026, EJ Green & Mason Westfall)
 - Puzzles about Belief (Fall 2025, Jeremy Goodman)
 - Truth-makers and Mental Models (Fall 2025, Justin Bledin)
- **Sorbonne Université³**
 - Philosophy of Techniques and Technology (Spring 2025, Anouk Barberousse)
 - Philosophy of Mathematics (Spring 2025, Olivier Rey)
 - Philosophy of Science in English IV (Spring 2025, Cécilia Bognon-Küss)
 - Metaphysics of Science (Fall 2024, Max Kistler)
 - Philosophy of Economics (Fall 2024, Cédric Paternotte)
 - Philosophy of Science in English III (Fall 2024, Anouk Barberousse)
 - Epistemology and Metaphysics (Spring 2024, Jean-Baptiste Rauzy)
 - Philosophy of Mind/Cognitive Science (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
 - The Implicit (Élise Marrou)
 - Advanced Logic (Spring 2024, Pascal Ludwig)
 - Philosophy of Science in English II (Spring 2024, Cédric Paternotte)

²Listed ENS courses were taught in English.

³Courses at Sorbonne Université were taught in French (titles translated by me), except 'Philosophy of Science in English' I-IV.

- Authenticity (Existentialism) (Spring 2024, Claude Romano)
- Scientific Reasoning (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
- Philosophy of Biology (Fall 2023, Cédric Paternotte)
- Philosophy of Physics (Fall 2023, Vincent Ardourel)
- Intro to Logic (Fall 2023, Isabelle Drouet)
- Philosophy of Science in English I (Fall 2023, Rayan Geha)
- Husserlian Phenomenology (Fall 2023, Dominique Pradelle)

References are available upon request.